PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, September 16, 2025

Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center , 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller and Virginia LaForte (Committee Chair)

Board Members (Non-Committee): Chair Eddie Wang and Director Patte Sullivan

Attendees:
Kimberlee Armstrong – Superintendent
Heidi Bertman – Program Senior Manager, Facilities
Donna Bezio – Project Manager, Office of School Modernization
Steve Effros – Project Manager, Office of School Modernization
Jon Franco – Senior Chief of Operations
Erk Gerding – Project Manager, Office of School Modernization
Marshall Haskins – Senior Director of Athletics
Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff
Liz Large – Contracted Senior Legal Counsel
Sarah Norman – Interim Senior Director, Office of School Modernization
Tom Odgers – Chief of Integrated Operations
Rosanne Powell – Senior Board Manager
Terry Proctor – Manager Multimedia Services

Call to Order and Introductions

Director La Forte called the meeting to order at 4:35 pm.

Public Comment

- Megan Steffek – advocating for the installation of artificial turf at Powell Park and would like to get an update on the collaboration with the City of Portland.
- Jan Watt – stated concerns about a contract with Procedeo Group and requested there be no delay in modernizing the remaining high schools.
- Laura Westwood – a parent of an Irvington Elementary student requested that there be a fence installed along Brazee Street.
- Neon Brooks – a member of Safe Structures advocated for finding ways to address critical seismic issues across the District.

Review Committee Charter

The committee recommends moving the proposed Committee Charter to the full Board for approval.

Revised Comprehensive Master Plans

Dr. Franco provided a summary of the total projected budgets for the modernizations of Cleveland, Ida B. Wells and Jefferson High Schools and shared that he was seeking Committee feedback. The Comprehensive Master Plans for each of the schools is slated to be voted on by the Board on October 14th.

Jefferson High School
Steven Effros shared a revised master plan with the cost reduction study adjustments. This includes reducing size, relocating the teen parent center, and moving the gym. He shared there would be a Community Information Session on October 15th. There was a Committee discussion about the need for Teen Parent Centers. The Committee also noted that they have achieved cost savings at the low end of the projected savings range. The next update will be shared at the October 8 Committee meeting.

Cleveland High School
Erik Gerding shared a revised master plan, including updated athletic facilities. He also shared that they are looking to have the stadium finished one year before the main building opens. He shared that the funds needed to improve Powell Park are included in the overall project budget. There is a planned Community Design Workshop on October 4th, and Special Education Educators are participating in the design process as well. There was Committee Discussion about the timing of completing improvements at Powell Park.

Ida B. Wells High School
Donna Bezio provided an overview of how they achieved a $5 million cost savings, and shared there would be more information provided at the end of September. She highlighted that they were able to keep the same number of parking spots and not move the athletic fields. There was discussion about finding a health care provider for the clinic. There was discussion about the Hillsdale Farmer's Market and the plan to have them move to a temporary location during construction. There were questions about the need for the use of the parking lot by contractors during the construction.

Athletics
Staff provided an update on the Grant Bowl lights and shared that there will be a more detailed athletic improvement overview at the next Committee meeting. There will be an overview of plans for middle schools in October and long-term facility plans for November.

Update: Athletics Facilities Improvement

There was an update on the timeline and next steps for getting additional staff help in the Office of School Modernization. There was a request for information about meetings that had occurred between Procedeo and staff.

Adjourn

Director La Forte adjourned the meeting at 6:34 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell, Senior Board Manager
Portland Public Schools